

Choosing your events

Nothing on this list is required. Keep, skip, or maybe, in the order of the night; the faint number is what each one usually costs the dance floor.

WEDDING 101
THE WORKSHEET

EVENT	KEEP, SKIP, MAYBE	MIN	WHAT IT NEEDS, WHO IS INVOLVED
Grand entrance 10	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
First dance 5	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Welcome or blessing 5	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Toasts 10	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
The meal 60	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Cake cutting 5	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Parent dances 10	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Anniversary dance 5	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Bouquet toss 10	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Garter 5	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Money dance people x 0.6	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Centerpiece giveaway 5	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Slideshow or montage its length	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
The shoe game 10	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Special or sorority songs 5	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
A surprise performance its length	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Last dance 5	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
Send-off 10	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		
	☐ Keep ☐ Skip ☐ Maybe		

Kept minutes, not counting the meal: Every one of these is a reason to sit down. Pick the best, not all of the good; more than thirty minutes of moments inside the dancing is where the floor starts to suffer.

Send-off supplies: one per guest plus ten percent. Line everyone up ten minutes before the last song ends. Sparklers are fireworks under Massachusetts law (M.G.L. c.148 s.39): no private sale, possession, or use without the state license and permits, and that covers ones bought out of state. Bubbles, petals, glow sticks, light-up wands, ribbon wands, the human tunnel, and the paparazzi exit all work at night and need no permit. Ask the venue either way.